

Israel halts aid after fighting in Gaza

Ceasefire holds as Netanyahu doesn't push return to war

By Josef Federman and Samy Magdy
Associated Press

JERUSALEM — The fragile ceasefire in Gaza faced its first major test Sunday as an Israeli security official said the transfer of aid into the territory was halted after Hamas militants killed two soldiers and Israeli forces launched a wave of deadly strikes.

The military later said it resumed enforcing the ceasefire, and the official confirmed that aid deliveries would resume Monday. The official spoke on condition of anonymity because he's not authorized to discuss the issue with the media.

A little over a week has passed since the start of the U.S.-proposed ceasefire aimed at ending two years of war. There was no immediate U.S. comment.

Health officials said at least 36 Palestinians were killed across Gaza, including children. Israel's military said it struck dozens of Hamas targets after its troops came under fire from Hamas in southern Gaza.

A senior Egyptian official involved in the ceasefire negotiations said "round-the-clock" contacts were underway to de-escalate the situation. The official spoke on condition of anonymity because he wasn't authorized to speak to reporters.

Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu directed the military to take "strong action" against truce violations but didn't threaten to return to war.

Israel's military said militants had fired at troops in areas of Rafah

city that are Israeli-controlled according to agreed-upon ceasefire lines.

Hamas, which continued to accuse Israel of multiple ceasefire violations, said communication with its remaining units in Rafah had been cut off for months and "we are not responsible for any incidents occurring in those areas."

Palestinians quickly feared a

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Trial set to begin for deputy in shooting

Downstate officer drew national attention over killing of Sonya Massey

By Jeremy Gornor
Chicago Tribune

SPRINGFIELD — Images of a slight Sonya Massey being fatally shot in the face by an imposing law enforcement officer inside her home in July 2024 shocked much of America.

The 36-year-old Black mother of two, who at the time was dealing with mental health challenges, had called police to her residence near Springfield because she said she was worried about a prowler. Mere minutes later, Sangamon County Deputy Sheriff Sean Grayson, who is white, killed her as he yelled for her to drop a pot of what he feared was boiling water.



Massey

On Monday, Grayson's first-degree murder trial begins 15 months after that fatal night. But for Massey's father, the trial is only a reminder of how much he's lost.

"I miss our long conversations. We would have conversations that were sometimes at least a couple of hours long," James Wilburn said in an interview earlier this month with the Tribune. "And we never, ever ended a conversation without her saying, 'I love you, Daddy.'"

"I think that anyone who looks at that tape and looks at it objectively will be horrified," he said. "It's the most horrifying tape that I've ever seen in my life. In my 67 years, I haven't seen anything like it."

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A Coco food delivery robot rolls along North Aberdeen Street at West Washington Boulevard in Chicago on Sept. 4. **TERRENCE ANTONIO JAMES/TRIBUNE**

Fruit-carrying bots pitch to customers in test run

Three suburban Jewel stores use robotic carts full of witty sayings to sell bananas

By Robert Channick
Chicago Tribune

From bananas to burgers, store aisles to sidewalks, an army of robots has descended upon Chicagoland with the singular mission to bring us food.

Robotic serving carts, once the stuff of foodie science fiction, are rolling among us in increas-

ing numbers to deliver meals on wheels to customers — whether they are ready or not.

Take Servi, an AI-powered robotic cart that has popped up recently in three suburban Jewel-Osco stores, following shoppers around the produce aisle and spouting prerecorded witticisms in an effort to sell bunches of bananas atop its trays.

"We're still gathering data, but so far, it shows very promising results," said Danny Dumas, senior vice president for Florida-based Fresh Del Monte, which is testing out the produce robots in the Chicago area for a potential national rollout. "The robot may have a voice that can scare a few people away, but overall, people like it."

Looking a lot like the self-driving restaurant serving cart it was designed to be, Servi would make a less than exciting "Transform-

ers" character, but is nonetheless an able addition to the ranks of food delivery robots hitting the streets of Chicago in recent months.

In July, a Chicago White Castle became the chain's first to offer robotic delivery, employing a fleet of autonomous outdoor delivery carts named Coco to fulfill late-night cravings for sliders on the Near West Side.

Last month, Serve Robotics

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Whistles take over city as a way to alert of ICE activity

Businesses have handed out thousands in Chicago

By Rebecca Johnson
Chicago Tribune

Owner Vanessa Aguirre-Avalos was busy watching over a small group of young children at Luna y Cielo Play Café when she heard what sounded like a helicopter circling over the neighborhood.

Concerned, she stepped outside to figure out what was going on. She watched as federal immigration agents passed by in trucks. Aguirre-Avalos immediately blew the whistle hanging around her neck.

"I was blowing the whistle several times. I don't know if I was even using the right cadence," she said about the scene she witnessed last month, which devolved into the agents throwing smoke canisters into the street just steps away from Funston Elementary School and her Logan Square play space. "But it was my first reaction, just to get people to know what was happening."

Aguirre-Avalos said the small, inexpensive devices are useful in

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STACEY WESCOTT/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Mount Prospect resident Lisa Porter screams at federal agents and tells them to leave as they sit in their SUV along East Busse Avenue on Sunday. Porter, several neighbors and local patrollers were upset to see so many federal agents in their community searching for a man agents say is a dangerous criminal.

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